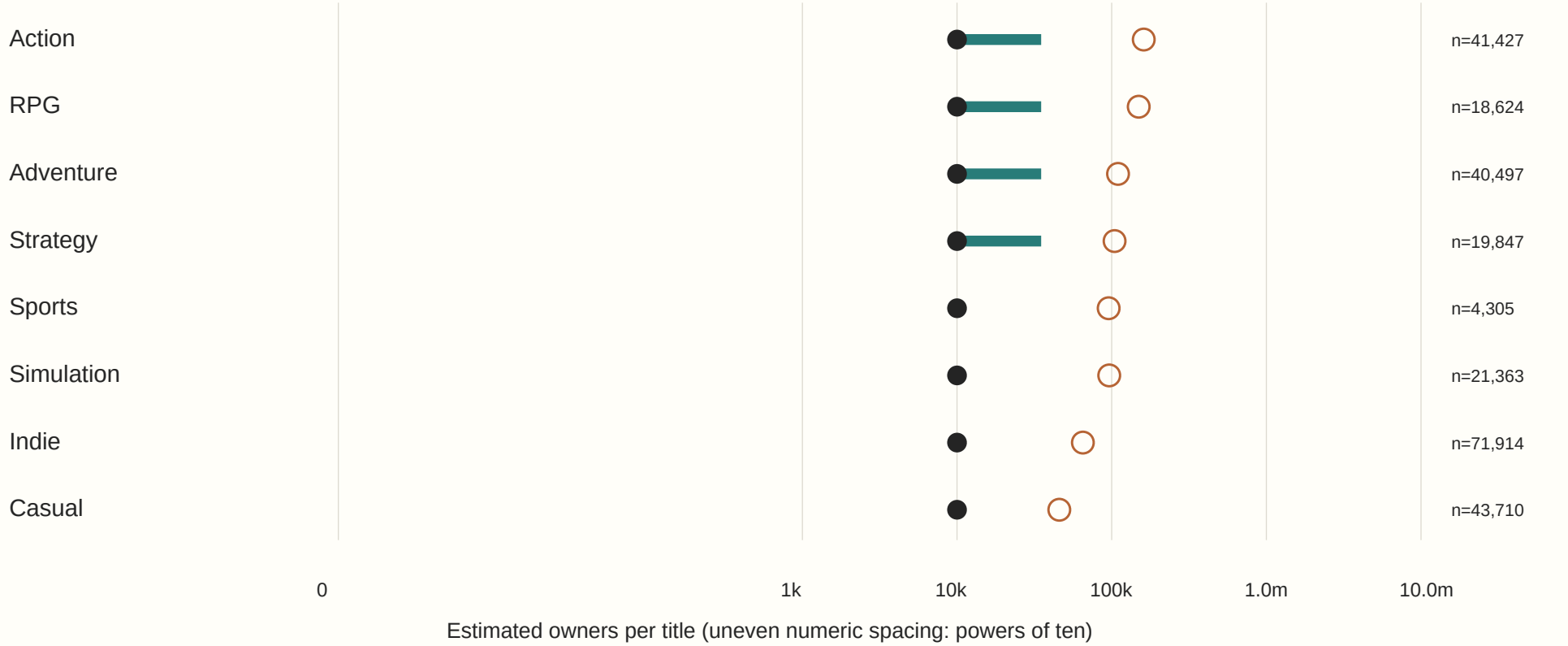
The genre race

Q1. Which game genres tend to attract the largest number of players?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.



LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Horizontal strokes = middle half of owner-band midpoints; black dot = median; open orange ring = mean (quantitative).

Row position + text = genre (nominal); x position = estimated owners (quantitative approximation). n = eligible games.

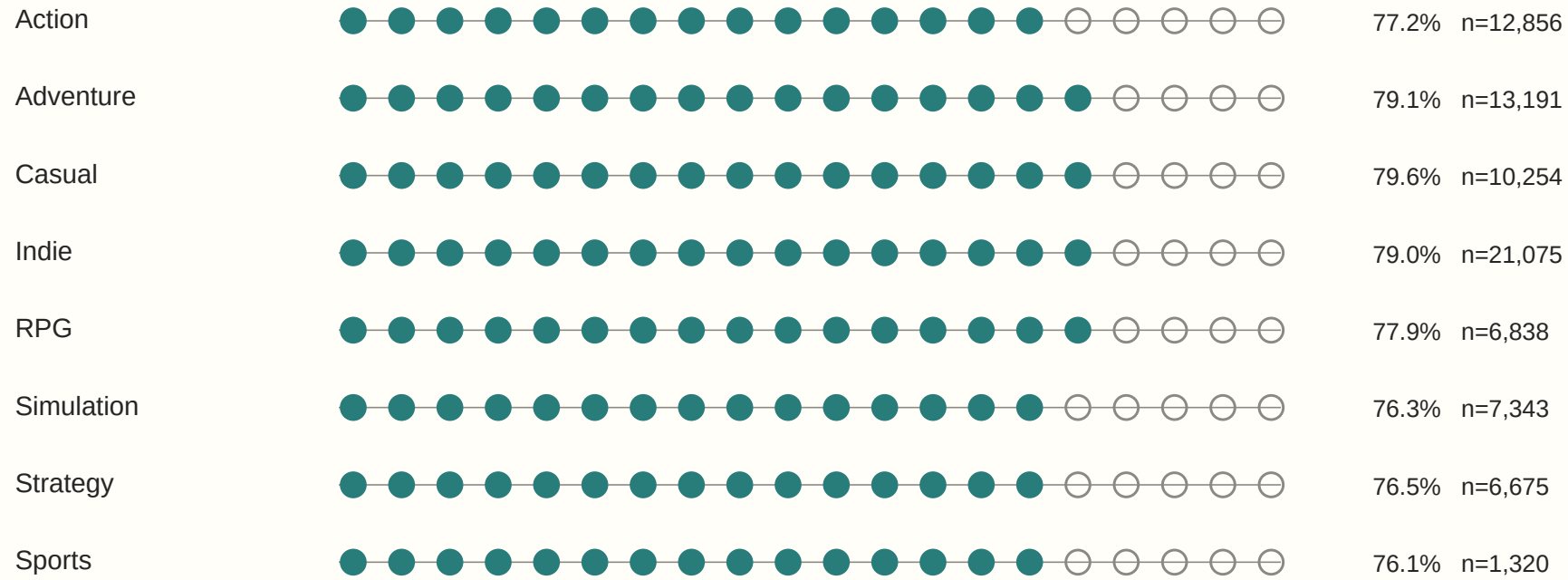
DRAW: Draw eight lanes, a thick interval, a dot and an open ring in each. Label the powers-of-ten ruler.

READ WITH CARE: Owners are not active players. Exclude 0-0 bands. Multi-genre games appear in each genre; lanes overlap.

Review bead strings

Q2. Which genres receive the highest percentage of positive user reviews?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.



LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Each bead = 5 percentage points of the mean per-game positive-review share; filled teal = positive, hollow = remainder.

Row/text = genre (nominal); filled-bead count = percentage (quantitative). Exact labels override rounded bead counts.

DRAW: Draw a 20-bead necklace per genre and shade the positive portion. Add the exact percentage at its end.

READ WITH CARE: Use games with >=50 reviews. Each game gets equal weight; this differs from pooling all review votes.

The playtime clock shop

Q7. Which genres have the highest average player playtime?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.

Action



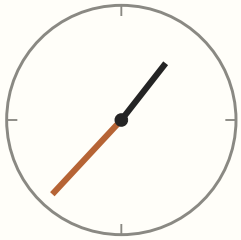
mean 9.3h / med 3.5h

Adventure



mean 14.1h / med 3.6h

Casual



mean 18.6h / med 3.2h

Indie



mean 14.6h / med 3.3h

RPG



mean 22.2h / med 5.1h

Simulation



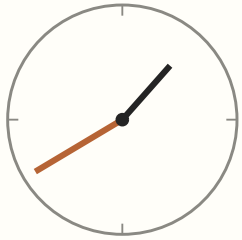
mean 16.1h / med 3.9h

Strategy



mean 15.8h / med 4.9h

Sports



mean 19.9h / med 3.5h

Every dial: 0 hours at top; one full turn = 30 hours

LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Circle = one genre (nominal); hand angle clockwise from 12 = hours (quantitative), all dials share the same scale.

Long orange hand = mean of game-average lifetime playtime; short black hand = median of those averages.

DRAW: Draw eight clocks with two differently sized hands. Label both hour values; add 0, quarter and half-turn ticks.

READ WITH CARE: Zeros are omitted as unavailable/ambiguous. This is a per-title summary, not a player-weighted average.

Price shelves

Q3-Q5. How does price relate to owners and reviews, and which price bands contain more high-reach games?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.

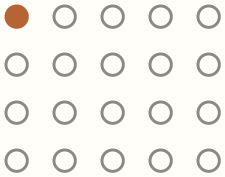
Free

Median owner band midpoint

10k

Mean review share

76.2%



2.8% high reach

n=9,954; rated=4,062

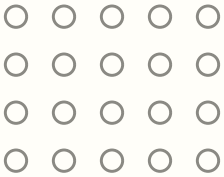
$0-5

Median owner band midpoint

10k

Mean review share

77.5%



0.8% high reach

n=61,749; rated=16,158

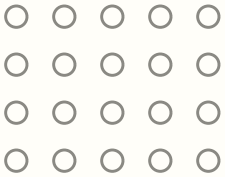
$5-10

Median owner band midpoint

10k

Mean review share

81.5%



1.5% high reach

n=18,280; rated=5,917

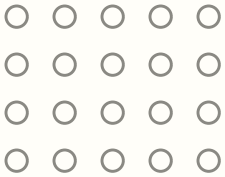
$10-20

Median owner band midpoint

10k

Mean review share

80.8%



2.1% high reach

n=8,995; rated=3,638

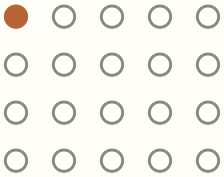
$20-40

Median owner band midpoint

10k

Mean review share

79.1%



4.8% high reach

n=1,685; rated=717

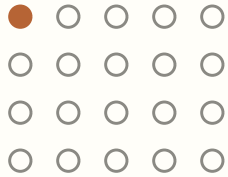
$40+

Median owner band midpoint

10k

Mean review share

74.0%



2.6% high reach

n=613; rated=132

LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Shelf position/text = ordered USD price bins; printed number = median owner midpoint; teal number = mean review share.

20-dot stamp = 100% of games in a shelf; filled orange dots = share with owner lower bound >=1m (rounded to 5%).

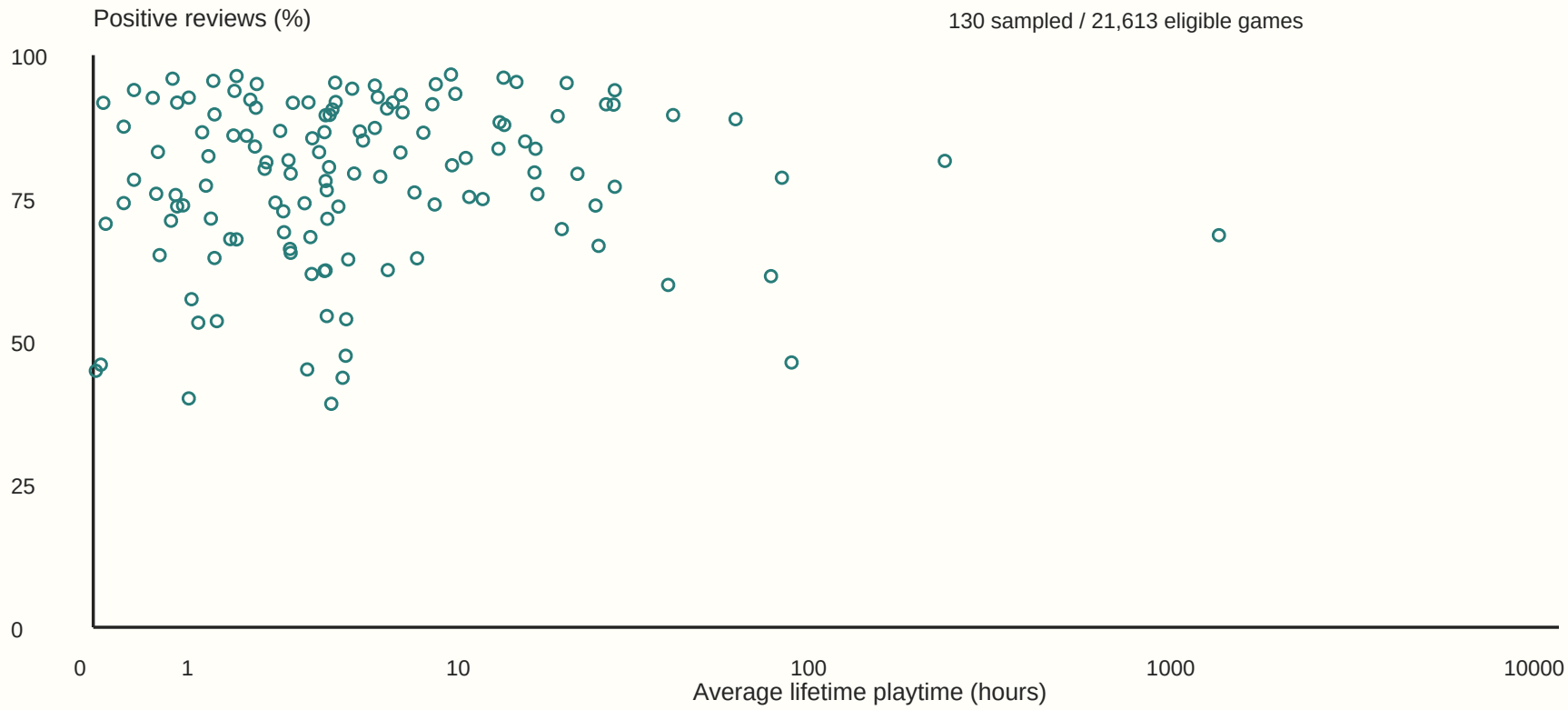
DRAW: Draw six shelf labels with an owner number, a review number and a small 20-dot stamp underneath.

READ WITH CARE: High reach is a chosen success proxy, not profit. Prices are snapshot prices. Exclude 0-0 owners; reviews need >=50.

The engagement constellation

Q6. Is average playtime associated with higher user review ratings?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.



LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

One open circle = one game (nominal identity); x = average lifetime hours; y = positive / total reviews x 100.

Both positions encode quantities. x uses log10(1+hours) to expose the long tail; point area is constant.

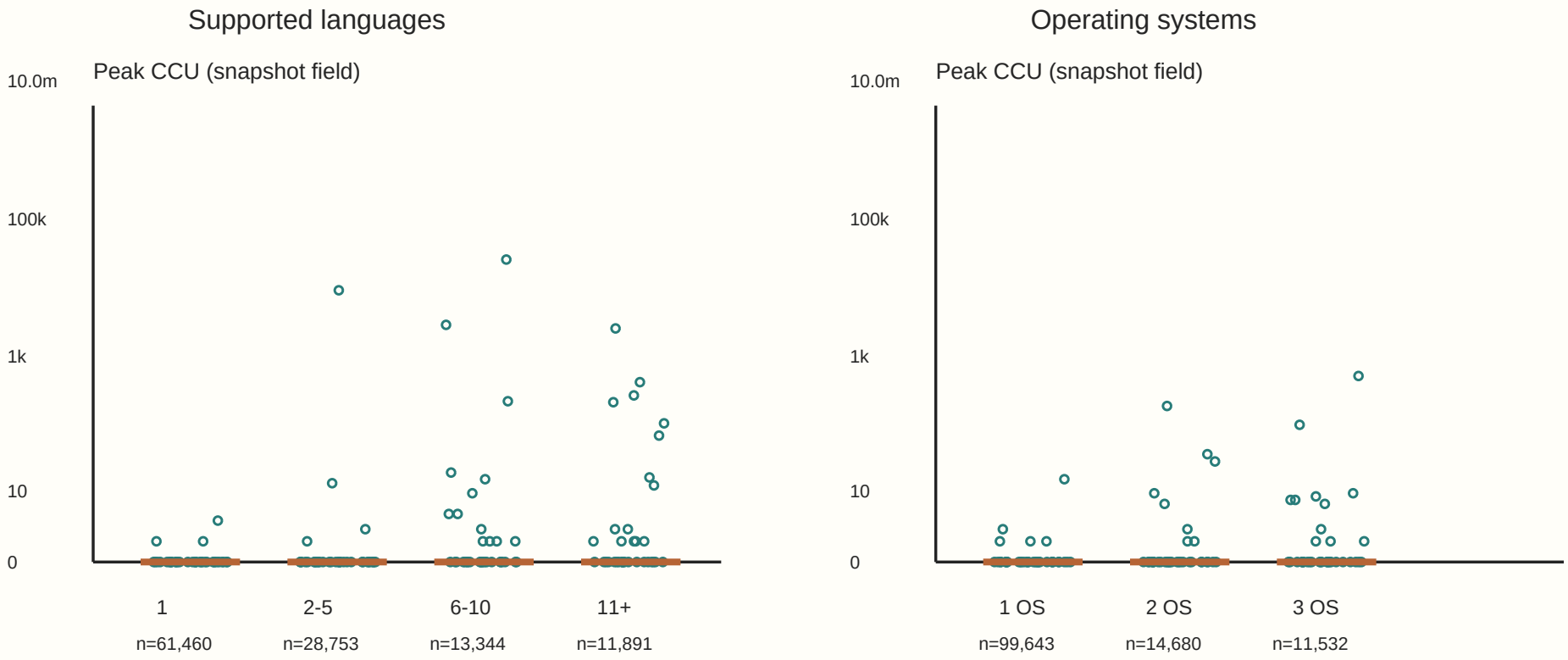
DRAW: Draw two axes and a loose cloud of circles. Circle interesting outliers and write their game names in a later version.

READ WITH CARE: Only nonzero playtime and >=50 reviews. A seeded sample shows the design; association does not establish causation.

Reach ladders: languages and platforms

Q8-Q9. Do more supported languages or operating systems accompany higher player reach?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.



LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Each circle = a sampled game; column position = ordered language-count or platform-count group; y = Peak CCU.

Orange rung = full-group median CCU. Within-column sideways jitter is only separation. y uses log10(1+CCU).

DRAW: Draw two ladders of point clouds. Cross each cloud with a median rung. Write group counts below.

READ WITH CARE: Unknown/zero support counts omitted; CCU zeros retained. The snapshot does not establish the CCU measurement window.

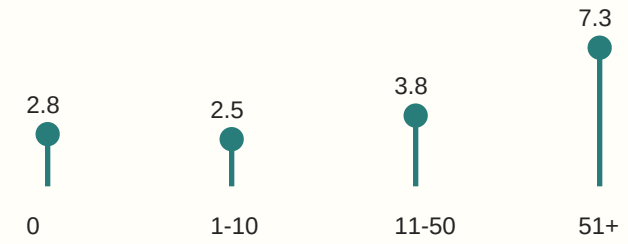
Achievement and DLC trails

Q10-Q11. Are achievements or DLCs associated with playtime or popularity?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.

Achievements

Median avg. playtime (h)

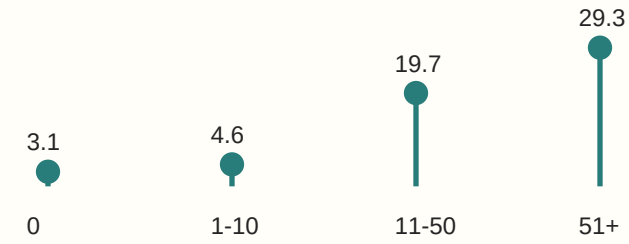


Median Peak CCU

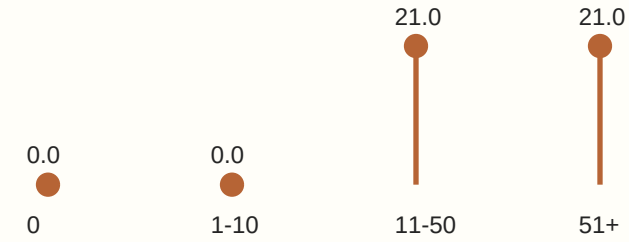


DLC count

Median avg. playtime (h)



Median Peak CCU



LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Stem + dot = one count bin; x order = achievement/DLC count (quantitative bins); stem length = group median.

Teal = hours among games with nonzero playtime; orange = Peak CCU including zeros. Each panel has its own scale.

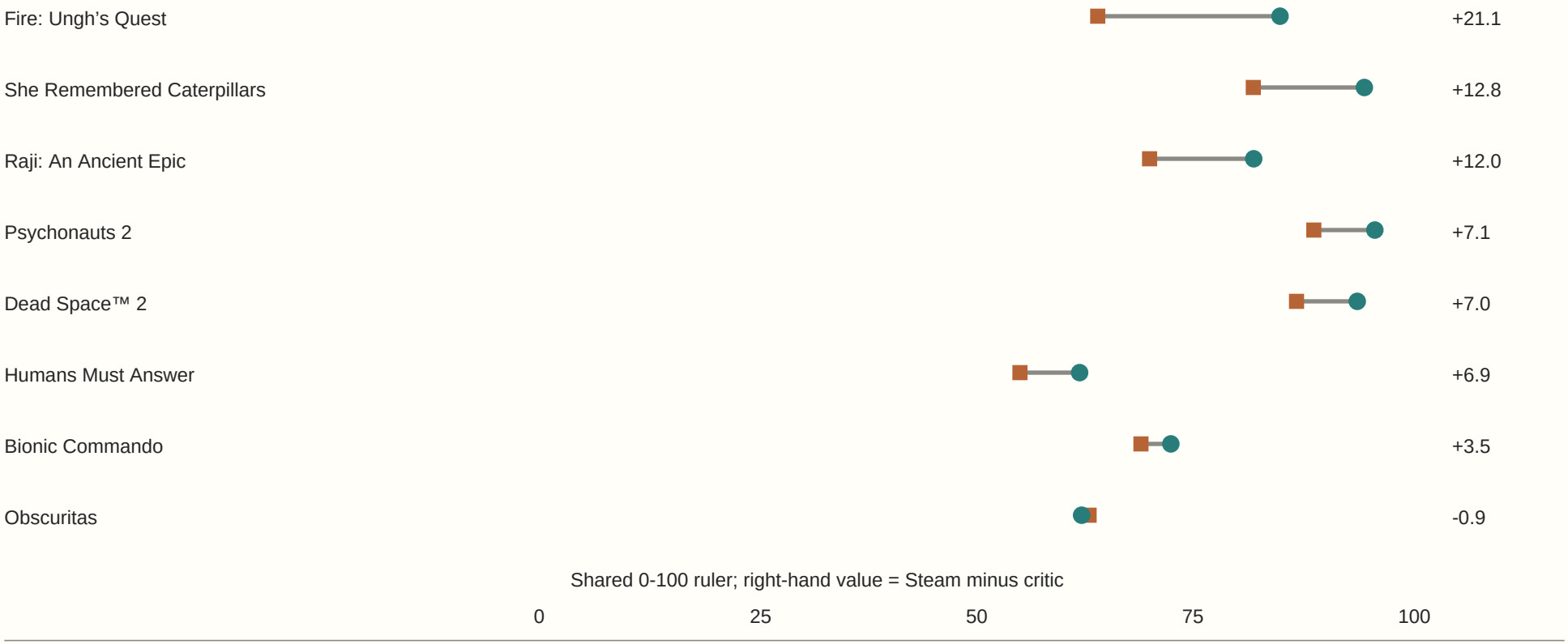
DRAW: Draw two pairs of four lollipops: achievements on the left, DLCs on the right. Label every tip value.

READ WITH CARE: These are associations; successful games may add features later. Zero playtime is omitted, so group populations differ.

Critic-player bridges

Q12. How closely do Metacritic scores align with Steam user reviews?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.



LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Row = named game; orange square = Metacritic score; teal circle = Steam positive-review %. x position = value.

Connecting stroke length = absolute numeric gap; signed label = direction and size of the gap (percentage points).

DRAW: Draw a square and circle on a shared ruler for each game, then bridge them. Long bridges reveal disagreement.

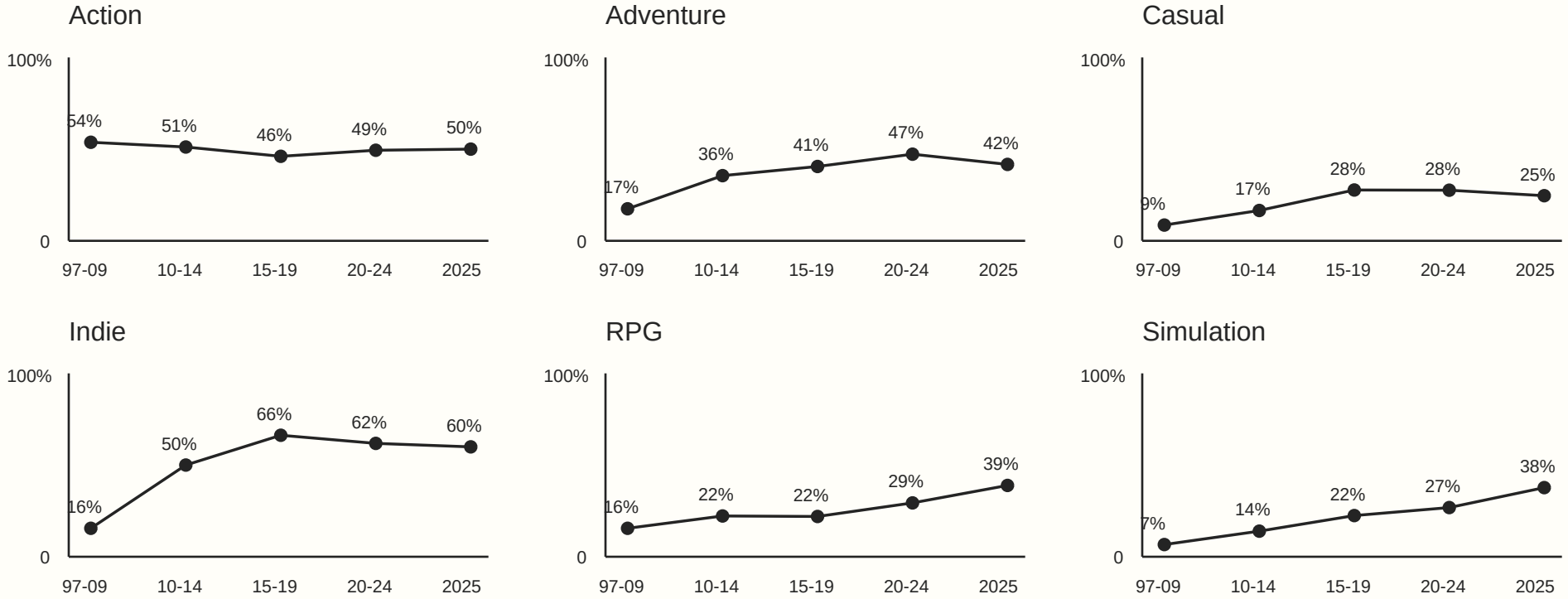
READ WITH CARE: Eight real sampled titles, not a ranking. Critics and Steam use different scoring systems; missing critics are excluded.

Which genres make up popular games?

Q13. How have popular game genres changed over time?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.

Popular = owner-band lower bound >=100,000. Compare genre shares among popular releases in each period.



Release periods: 1997-2009, 2010-2014, 2015-2019, 2020-2024, 2025. All panels use 0-100%.

Popular games per period (denominators): 361, 1,390, 3,461, 3,355, 252. Six selected genres.

LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Black dot = one genre/period; height = % of popular games from that period belonging to the genre (quantitative).

Left-to-right position = ordered release cohort; panel title = genre. Lines connect cohorts; labels round to whole %.

DRAW: Draw six sets of axes. In each, place five dots, connect them with straight lines, and write the percentages.

READ WITH CARE: Games may have several genres, so shares overlap. Snapshot owners favor older titles; this is not past player activity.

The high-reach fingerprint

Q15. What characteristics commonly co-occur among highly successful Steam games?

Computed from the local CSV. Digital sketch reference; redraw with pen on paper.



Example joint profile: Action + <=$10 + 2/3 OS = 16.0% of high-reach games

All known-owner games n=101,276; high-reach games n=1,354

LEGEND / MARKS + CHANNELS

Paired strokes = share of games satisfying a feature; length on a shared 0-100% scale = prevalence (quantitative).

Gray = all known-owner games; teal = owner lower bound >=1m. Labels = categorical/binary features. Joint count below.

DRAW: Draw paired bars like fingerprints. Then connect selected features and write their jointly matching share underneath.

READ WITH CARE: * Missing reviews/playtime do not satisfy the feature. Marginal bars cannot identify the most common joint combination.